

Response to Reviewer Comments

We thank both reviewers for their constructive and detailed feedback. All remarks have been addressed in the revised manuscript, as detailed below.

Reviewer 1 – Content Recommendations

Rec. 1 (ISO/IEC TS 20000-16:2025 depth). The revised Section 2.3 now explicates the clause structure of ISO/IEC TS 20000-16:2025 and identifies the two most direct entry points for code-level green coding requirements: the operation of the SMS clauses (governing change and release) and the performance evaluation and improvement clauses; planning and support clauses are noted as further, if less direct, anchors. We also make explicit that the specification deliberately withholds performance criteria, so no code-level indicator is currently defined or auditable — framing this as part of the normative gap rather than a settled mechanism.

Rec. 2 (Why Green Coding belongs in ITSM). The revised Introduction adds an explicit paragraph motivating this intersection before the research questions. Three arguments are given: (1) ITSM is already the governance layer for change, release, and continual improvement of the software that constitutes services; (2) ITSM frameworks treat energy efficiency as one more service attribute alongside availability or security — attributes that likewise originate in engineering yet are governed through ITSM processes; (3) without an organizational anchor, code-level practices remain isolated developer interventions not sustained across releases or supplier boundaries. A fourth, more concrete argument is added: the German IT-Planungsrat coordinates ITIL-based ITSM top-down across all administrative levels, meaning any attached sustainability clause propagates as a coordinated requirement rather than a voluntary one.

Rec. 3 (GREENS 2026 dependency and independent research). Section 4.2 now contains an explicit paragraph acknowledging that the theoretical case for an ITIL–green coding integration rests directly on the authors' own GREENS 2026 paper, which itself frames the mapping as an outlook rather than a validated model. We further note that the systematic corpus search — designed precisely to surface independent work — returned no third-party Tier-1 source combining green coding with ITIL specifically, and that the leverage-point mapping should therefore be read as a first elaboration of a single research group's outlook. Independent replication is listed explicitly as a future research direction, and this dependency is also recorded in the revised Limitations subsection.

Reviewer 2 – Bibliographic Remarks

All bibliographic entries have been revised accordingly: German titles now follow correct German capitalisation, English titles apply standard title case throughout, and personal notes as well as German-language comments have been removed from all entries. The "Zugriff" field was converted to the standard urldate attribute — however, as the Springer Nature SNmult/plainnat template does not render this field in the printed output, it has no visible effect and the access date is effectively suppressed, which is acceptable for the purposes of this publication. The changes affect references [1], [2], [3], [4], [6], [9], [10], [11], [12], [14], [18], [33], and further entries where the same issues were present.

As a secondary effect, the removal of inline notes and the reformatting of titles reduced the overall length of the bibliography, which partially offset the additional space introduced by the content revisions elsewhere in the manuscript and helped bring the paper within the target page limit.